Five Spooky Sky Targets to Spot This Halloween

From: Space.com Mined: 2026-10-24 3 min read

Halloween is a great time to look up at the night sky. You need no telescope for these targets, just a dark sky and patience. First, find the **Pleiades**, a group that looks like six or seven bright stars. With **binoculars** you can see dozens more from a **cluster** of about 1,000 stars. Celtic druids once marked Samhain, an early Halloween, by the **Pleiades**. From the United States, find Orion's Belt, follow a line up to orange Aldebaran, then look higher. Next is Algol, the Demon Star, in Perseus. It is really two stars orbiting each other; every 2.867 days one passes in front of the other, making Algol about 3.3 times dimmer for 10 hours. It will not be **eclipsed** on Halloween night in 2026, but dimming may show near October 29 and November 1. Then look southeast after sunset for Cetus, the sea monster near the **Pleiades**. Around the October 26 full moon, look for bright streaks around the Moon craters Tycho, Copernicus, and Kepler. Finally, watch for the bright, slow Taurid **meteors** streaking away near the **Pleiades**.

Word Treasure

Pleiades -- A group of stars that looks like six or seven bright stars.
binoculars -- A tool with two small telescopes that makes far things look closer.
cluster -- A group of stars close together in the sky.
eclipsed -- Blocked from view when one object passes in front of another.
meteors -- Bright streaks of light made by space rocks burning up in the sky.

Background you need

Some star groups are easy to spot with no telescope, just a dark sky and patience.

The Pleiades look like six or seven bright stars, but binoculars show dozens more from a cluster of about 1,000 stars.

Algol is really two stars orbiting each other, and one passing in front makes it dimmer.

Break it down

WHO: Stargazers and readers looking up at the night sky.
WHAT: Five spooky sky targets to spot at Halloween.
WHERE: The night sky, seen from the United States.
WHY: Halloween is a great time to look up, and these targets need no telescope.

Why it matters

Looking up at the stars is a free adventure you can start in your own backyard tonight.

Test what you remember

1. What do you need to spot these targets?

- (A) A large telescope
- (B) A spaceship
- (C) Just a dark sky and patience
- (D) Special glasses

2. What do the Pleiades look like?

- (A) A comet
- (B) Six or seven bright stars
- (C) A ring
- (D) One red star

3. What did Celtic druids once mark by the Pleiades?

- (A) The new year
- (B) Samhain, an early Halloween
- (C) Easter
- (D) Christmas

4. What is Algol really?

- (A) A black hole
- (B) Two stars orbiting each other
- (C) One dying star
- (D) A planet

5. How often does one Algol star pass in front of the other?

- (A) Once a year
- (B) Every 10 hours
- (C) Every night
- (D) Every 2.867 days

6. Around the October 26 full moon, what should you look for?

- (A) Bright streaks around the Moon craters Tycho, Copernicus, and Kepler
- (B) A solar eclipse
- (C) A new planet
- (D) Falling snow

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):